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Who will pay Trump’s tariffs? Look in the mirror.

Despite president’s boasts, they’re ultimately a tax on Americans, experts say

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As the latest round of high tariffs was about to kick in Wednesday night, President Trump took to his social media site and declared: “IT’S MIDNIGHT!!! BILLIONS OF DOLLARS IN TARIFFS ARE NOW FLOWING INTO THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA!”

He’s right about the amount of money — a record \$29.6 billion from his tariffs in July alone. But not about where it’s “flowing” from.

Tariffs are collected when foreign goods arrive at the border and are paid by the business bringing them into the country. So they amount to a back-door tax increase on US businesses and consumers, and in particular hit lower-income people harder.

“Tariff is basically a euphemism for a tax,” said Boston College economist Brian Bethune, who equated it to state sales taxes. “It’s no different than any other tax on . . . products and services.”

The reality stands in stark contrast with Republicans’ recent sweeping, party-line legislation, which they have touted for extending the

TARIFFS, Page A6

Colleges may have to give more data on admissions

By Anjali Huynh and Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

President Trump signed a memorandum Thursday that could require universities to hand over more admissions data — a move some fear could leave universities vulnerable to attacks from conservatives who believe schools are illegally considering race while admitting students.

The Trump administration said the measure — a directive to the Department of Education — would help it test whether institutions are in compliance with a 2023 Supreme Court ruling that ended the use of race-based affirmative action in college admissions. Since then, many top schools nationwide, including nearly a dozen schools in Massachusetts, saw the number of Black students they enroll sharply decline.

While many universities have diminished race as a factor in whom they let in, the Trump administration has made diversity policies a centerpiece of its pressure campaign against colleges and universities. One of the key demands the government has made of schools, including Harvard University, is for them to submit more information about applicants, such as demographic information and test scores.

“The persistent lack of available data —

ADMISSIONS, Page A6



JEHAD ALSHRAFI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Palestinians rushed to collect humanitarian aid that was airdropped by parachutes into Gaza City on Thursday.

Netanyahu points to escalation

Says Israel plans to take entire Gaza Strip; military, hostage families push back



Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the move would “assure our security.”

By Adam Rasgon, Natan Odenheimer, and Ronen Bergman

NEW YORK TIMES

TEL AVIV — Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said Thursday that Israel plans to take control of all of the Gaza Strip, bucking the advice of the Israeli military and warnings that expanding operations could endanger the hostages being held there and kill more Palestinian civilians.

Netanyahu made the comments in an interview with Fox News before a security Cabinet meeting Thursday to discuss a proposal to expand military operations in Gaza. The comments came as talks to achieve a cease-fire and the release of the hostages

have hit an impasse, with Israeli and Hamas officials blaming each other for the deadlock.

When asked whether Israel would take over all of Gaza, he responded, “We intend to.”

Netanyahu said the move would “assure our security,” remove Hamas from power, and enable the transfer of the civilian administration of Gaza to another party.

“We want to liberate ourselves and the people of Gaza from the awful terror of Hamas,” he said in an excerpt from the interview, without providing details on any planned operation.

The prime minister, however, suggested Israel is not interested in maintaining permanent control over

ISRAEL, Page A4

Rent control backers will have a fight on their hands

Real estate industry ready to mobilize again

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

The cycle repeats every other year in Massachusetts: A few legislators file a bill to legalize rent control — which voters here outlawed in 1994 — citing soaring rents and struggling families. Advocates rally in front of the State House, telling stories of tenants forced from their homes by double-digit rent increases and citing polls that show strong statewide sup-

port for the policy.

And then the legislative session comes to an end, and the efforts quietly languish.

While lawmakers have historically been skeptical of rent control, perhaps the single biggest reason the policy fails and fails again is the opposition of the state’s powerful real estate industry, which has interceded in the legislative process to kill numerous proposals backed by tenant

advocates over the years.

Now the industry faces a challenge on a new front, the ballot box, after housing advocates Wednesday filed a petition to put rent caps on the ballot in November 2026.

It’s a long road to Election Day, and many proposed ballot initiatives fail to qualify and make it to voters. Nonetheless, real estate industry representatives said they are alarmed by the proposal and are prepared to spend heavily to fight it.

“It’s such a punitive form of rent

control, it almost exudes the frustration of tenants and tenant advocates with the real estate industry. . . . It reads like it is designed to punish corporations and landlords,” said Greg Vasil, chief executive of the Greater Boston Real Estate Board. “But this would be a disaster for Massachusetts. We will absolutely campaign against it.”

The measure filed by tenant advocate coalition Homes For All Massachusetts would limit annual rent in-

RENT CONTROL, Page A7



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

DIGGING INTO THE PAST

History has always been a major draw in Boston, particularly this year with the anniversary of the American Revolution, and History Camp Boston will bring enthusiasts together this weekend. The camp falls under the umbrella of Pursuit of History, which operates tours, such as a recent one offering a look inside the Jason Russell House in Arlington at items lost by British soldiers. **B1.**

President Vladimir Putin confirmed plans to meet with President Trump and said the United Arab Emirates would be a suitable location. **A3.**

The Boston Legacy Football Club ownership got a six-week extension to wrap up financing for its part of the White Stadium redevelopment. **B1.**

How Roman Anthony’s signing came together. **C1.**

Clearing the air

Friday: Sunny, pleasant. High 76-81. Low 61-66.

Saturday: More of the same. High 74-79. Low 62-67.

Sunrise: 5:44 Sunset: 7:55

Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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\$4.00



conservative supermajority Supreme Court and a public narrative that DEI is unfair to them.”

The Meltzer Center, which runs a website that tracks lawsuits aimed at halting DEI policies, lists 11 suits filed in federal court so far this year by white

►**Being replaced by another white, blond anchor could weaken Merrill’s case, writes Shirley Leung. B5.**

plaintiffs alleging workplace racial discrimination, not counting Merrill’s lawsuit. That compares to 12 such suits in all of 2024.

Meanwhile, President Trump has signed executive orders aimed at uprooting DEI programs throughout the federal government. In addition, the Justice Department has threatened le-

LAWSUIT, Page A7